Project Deep Dive, Technical Reasoning & Follow-up Handling

第五课 | 项目深挖、技术说明与追问应对

Move from “I worked on it” to “I can explain it under pressure.”

- Why interviewers dig deeper
- How to explain decisions and trade-offs
- How to stay clear during follow-up questions

DevOps + Web3 case study inside

Why Interviewers Deep Dive Into Projects

They are not only checking what you built — they are checking how you think.

Ownership
Did you really handle this part, or are you repeating team-level information?

Depth
Do you understand the system beyond the headline or architecture diagram?

Judgment
Can you explain why a technical decision made sense in that context?

Pressure handling
Can you stay clear when questions become detailed and less predictable?

Engineering maturity
Do you understand constraints, trade-offs, and operational reality?

Key message

Follow-up questions are not random. They separate “headline knowledge” from real understanding.

Common Follow-up Question Types

Prepare by category, not by memorizing isolated answers.

Why

Why did you choose this solution?

How

How did it work in practice?

What if

What if traffic spiked or the node failed?

Trade-off

What did you gain and what did you accept?

Ownership

Which part did you personally handle?

Result

What changed after you implemented it?

准备思路：先按 why / how / trade-off / ownership 四类练，再补 what-if 和 result。

A Strong Framework for Deep-Dive Answers

Use a more engineering-focused structure than a basic STAR answer.

Context	What was the service or project?
Problem	What specific challenge or limitation existed?
Decision	What did you choose, and why?
Action	What did you personally do?
Result	What improved in the end?
Reflection	What would you improve next time?

Why this works

- Gives context before details
- Shows decision quality, not just action
- Creates a natural path for follow-up
- Keeps complex answers structured

How to Explain Technical Decisions and Trade-offs

Move from naming tools to explaining why the decision made sense.

Thin answer

"We used Docker because it was convenient."

" We used Kubernetes because it was scalable."

Problem: correct words, but weak reasoning.

Stronger answer pattern

- Constraint or problem: what were you trying to solve?
- Reason: why did this option fit the context?
- Trade-off: what did you gain and what did you accept?
- Outcome: what difference did it make in practice?

Example: "We used Docker to standardize the runtime environment across dev, staging, and production. The trade-off was extra image/version management, but the consistency benefit was worth it."

Case Study: DevOps + Web3 Infrastructure

A practical example that combines Docker, Kubernetes, Shell, AWS, Linux, and Web3 dependencies.

Project snapshot

- Web3-related backend service consuming on-chain data
- Docker for packaging and environment consistency
- Kubernetes for rollout, restart, and availability
- AWS to support surrounding cloud infrastructure
- Shell scripts for health checks and restart routines

Challenge: external RPC dependencies could become slow or unstable, making the service harder to operate reliably.

Answer shape

Context	Web3 data service + Linux-based production
Problem	RPC instability and operational recovery risk
Decision	Standardize deployment and improve observability
Action	Docker + K8s + Shell + AWS support workflows
Result	More stable deployments, less manual overhead

How to Stay Calm During Follow-up Questions

Structure buys time. Scope-setting prevents panic.

1) Summarize the question

"So if I understand correctly, you're asking about…"
"Let me break that into two parts."

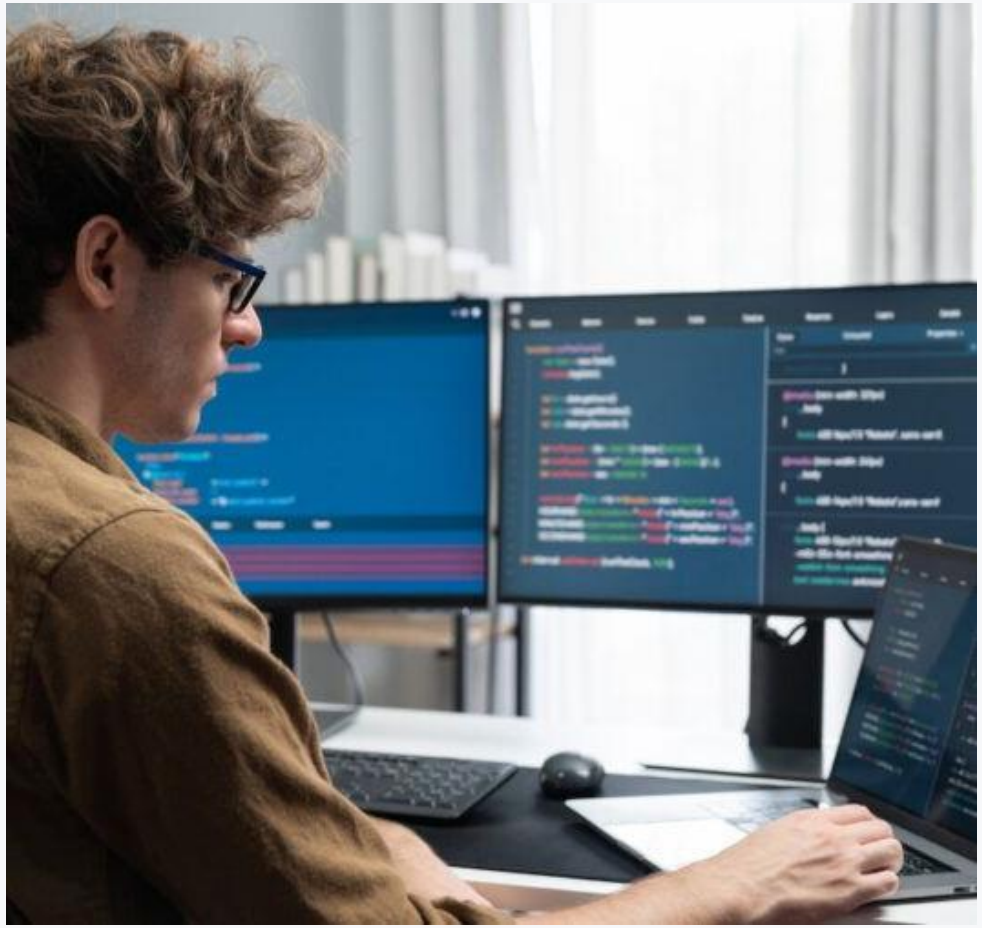
2) Give the high-level answer first

"At a high level, the reason was…"
"The short answer is…"

3) Set scope when needed

"I wasn't the only person involved, but my part was mainly…"
"Based on what I handled…"

These phrases improve clarity without making you sound weak.



Linking Phrases + Sample Deep-Dive Prompts

Prepare the structure, not just the content.

Useful linking phrases

- At a high level, …
- The main reason was …
- Compared with the alternative, …
- The trade-off was …
- My main responsibility was …
- As a result, …
- If I understand correctly, you're asking about …

Sample prompts to rehearse

- Why did you choose Docker for that project?
- Why Kubernetes instead of a simpler deployment model?
- What was one major challenge in that Web3 infra service?
- What exactly was your role in that part?
- If you had more time, what would you improve?

Advice: prepare one strong answer per prompt using Context → Problem → Decision → Action → Result → Reflection.